

INSIGHTS & OPPORTUNITIES

GREATER NASHVILLE
MUSIC CENSUS



THE HEADLINES

- 1 NASHVILLE IS LIKE NO OTHER
- 2 (ALL) MUSIC CITY
- 3 UNAFFORDABLE
- 4 A SEAT AT THE TABLE
- 5 OUT OF HARMONY

NASHVILLE IS LIKE NO OTHER

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

INSIGHT

THE NUMBERS DON'T LIE, NASHVILLE IS TRULY MUSIC CITY, WITH CENSUS SETTING MULTIPLE NEW BENCHMARKS ACROSS NATIONAL COHORT.

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)

SUPPORTING DATA

RESPONDENTS: 4256

EMPLOYED IN INDUSTRY: 31%

AVG ANNUAL MUSIC INCOME: 52K

TOTAL ANNUAL INCOME GENERATED: 220M

AVG # OF EVENTS PER VENUE: 172

TOTAL # OF EVENTS: 25,087

ALL NEW RECORDS!

OPPORTUNITIES

TOURISM/CHAMBER/ECD/COLLEGE
WORKFORCE RECRUITMENT TOOL.



(ALL) MUSIC CITY

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)

INSIGHT

REPRESENTATION ACROSS GENRES AND GENDERS IS SURPRISINGLY STRONG, BUT STILL MOSTLY WHITE.

OPPORTUNITIES

WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT PROGRAM TO INCREASE ACCESS/OPPORTUNITIES FOR UNDERREPRESENTED POPULATIONS.

SUPPORTING DATA

COUNTRY STILL LEADS THE PACK, BUT GENRE DIVERSITY IS STRONG

FEMALE REPRESENTATION IN CREATIVE SECTOR IS LOW, BUT WITHIN THE INDUSTRY AND VENUES IS A NATIONAL HIGH

THE NASHVILLE MUSIC ECOSYSTEM IS PREDOMINANTLY WHITE INDIVIDUALS

(ALL) MUSIC CITY

SUPPORTING DATA - **GENRE**

COUNTRY: 28%

AMERICAN ROOTS: 16%

ROCK: 12%

POP: 8%

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)



(ALL) MUSIC CITY

SUPPORTING DATA - GENDER

WHILE FEMALE REPRESENTATION IN THE CREATIVE SECTOR IS VERY LOW, THE INDUSTRY AND VENUE #S HIT A NATIONAL HIGH.

FEMALES IN VENUES: 50%

FEMALES IN INDUSTRY: 55%

FEMALES IN CREATIVES: 26%

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)



(ALL) MUSIC CITY

SUPPORTING DATA - RACE

CAUCASIAN: 85%

VS 71% OF GENERAL POPULATION

BIPOC: 6%

VS 14% OF GENERAL POPULATION

HISPANIC: 4%

VS 8% OF GENERAL POPULATION

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)



(ALL) MUSIC CITY

OPPORTUNITIES

INDUSTRY AND/OR PUBLIC SECTOR LED WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT
PROGRAM TO INCREASE ACCESS/OPPORTUNITIES FOR
UNDERREPRESENTED POPULATIONS.

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)



UNAFFORDABLE

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)

INSIGHT

BOTH QUANTITATIVE AND QUALITATIVE DATA
HIGHLIGHT AN IMMANENT AFFORDABILITY
CRISIS FOR THE NASHVILLE MUSIC
COMMUNITY.

OPPORTUNITIES

MUSIC FRIENDLY POLICIES ARE NEEDED
INVESTMENT IN THE NEW TN LIVE MUSIC FUND
MORE AFFORDABLE HOUSING OPPORTUNITIES
BETTER TRANSIT OPPORTUNITIES

SUPPORTING DATA

TOP CONCERNS

#1 RISING COST OF LIVING
#2 STAGNANT PAY RATES

TOP COMPLAINT

PARKING COST AND POLICIES

MIGRATION

30% OF RESPONDENTS OUTSIDE COUNTIES

A SEAT AT THE TABLE

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)

INSIGHT

WHILE NASHVILLE'S MUSIC INDUSTRY LEADS THE NATION ECONOMICALLY, ITS MEMBERS ARE NOT ADEQUATELY REPRESENTED WITHIN LOCAL GOVERNMENT.

OPPORTUNITIES

DEDICATED LOCAL GOVERNMENT ADVOCATE AND FUNDING FOR ADEQUATE STAFFING

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT INCENTIVES

CROSS SECTOR ASSOCIATION OR COALITION FORMATION

SUPPORTING DATA

73% OF VENUES/PRESENTERS SEEK AN ADVOCATE INSIDE LOCAL GOVERNMENT

79% OF VENUES/PRESENTERS SEEK TO BE A PART OF ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT CONVERSATIONS

GREATER NASHVILLE
MUSIC CENSUS



OUT OF HARMONY

A QUALITATIVE ANALYSIS OF CENSUS COMMENTS SPOTLIGHTS A GROWING TREND OF FRUSTRATION, UNCERTAINTY, AND LACK OF INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT.

“

DOWNTOWN NASHVILLE IS REALLY FUELED BY LIVE MUSIC, BUT THE INFRASTRUCTURE ISN'T NECESSARILY CONDUCTIVE FOR A MUSICIAN TO THRIVE.

”

“

HIGH LIVING COSTS ARE DRIVING MUSICIANS OUT OF THE CITY.

”

“

WE NEED MORE SUPPORT FOR INDEPENDENT VENUES TO THRIVE ADMIDST CORPORATE TAKEOVERS.

”

“

IT'S HARD TO GET SMALL, MORE ART-LED, CREATIVE PROJECTS OFF THE GROUND WITHOUT GRANTS OR FUNDING BECAUSE OF HIGH COST OF LIVING.

”

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

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OUT OF HARMONY

A QUALITATIVE ANALYSIS OF CENSUS COMMENTS SPOTLIGHTS A GROWING TREND OF FRUSTRATION, UNCERTAINTY, AND LACK OF INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT.

“
CREATIVE PROFESSIONALS
FEEL UNSUPPORTED BY
STATE AND LOCAL
GOVERNMENTS.
”

“
REAL ESTATE PRICES ARE
SKYROCKETING, PUSHING
OUT LOCAL MUSICIANS
AND ARTISTS.
”

“
POLICIES SHOULD
BE DESIGNED TO
NURTURE AND
PROTECT
NASHVILLE’S
CULTURAL
HERITAGE.
”

“
THERE’S VERY LITTLE COMMUNICATION
AND UNDERSTANDING BETWEEN SECTORS
OF THE MUSIC INDUSTRY AND LOCAL
GOVERNMENT. TRANSPARENCY AND
PARTNERSHIP WOULD BE A CATALYST
FOR GROWTH AND A HEALTHIER
ENVIRONMENT.
”

FULL DATA DASHBOARD:

[MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM](https://musiccitycensus.com)



OPPORTUNITIES

**STRATEGIC CROSS SECTOR PARTNERSHIP(S) AND
COALITION DEVELOPMENT TO FURTHER ENHANCE
BENEFITS OF NASHVILLE'S TOURISM INDUSTRY
WITHIN NASHVILLE'S DIVERSE LOCAL MUSIC
COMMUNITY.**

TOP OPPS - RECAP

-  **MORE MUSIC FRIENDLY POLICIES**
-  **INVESTMENT IN LIVE MUSIC FUND**
-  **STRATEGIC CROSS SECTOR PARTNERSHIP**
-  **DEDICATED METRO FUNDING**
-  **WORKFORCE DEV PROGRAMMING**

GET INVOLVED:

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FULL REPORT + DATA DASHBOARD:

MUSICCITYCENSUS.COM



MADE POSSIBLE BY



THANK YOU

GREATER NASHVILLE
MUSIC CENSUS

